

Monday, 25 May 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Clear

34° 22°

BIRMINGHAM

Clear

33° 19°

MANCHESTER

Clear

32° 17°

GLASGOW

Overcast

23° 13°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- Farage was issued with court judgement for £9,400 debt.**
Reform UK says Farage will appeal the County Court judgment because he had not been aware of the claim.
POLITICS · UK

- Appeal after Hyde Park Corner cyclist-lorry crash.**
A major dual carriageway linking Hyde Park Corner with Victoria along the perimeter of Buckingham Palace was closed on Saturday.
UK · NEWS

- Man dies after falling from city centre building.**
A forensic tent is in place outside the Maldron hotel with road closures in place.
UK · NEWS

02 – SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

- 1 Musicals are living their High Life in Scotland, says Alan Cumming.**
The star says a surge in new productions is driving growing interest in musical theatre across Scotland.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 2 Drake's surprise three-album drop makes UK chart history.**
The Canadian rapper becomes the first artist to debut three studio albums inside the top 10.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 3 How to keep cool at your summer festivals.**
As the summer festival season kicks off, temperatures are set to soar this bank holiday weekend.
SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

- 1 'Not mentally doable to stay like this' - Verstappen renews quit threat.**
Max Verstappen threatens to quit Formula 1 at the end of this season if planned changes to the engine regulations are blocked.
SPORT · UK
- 2 Cut-price Leao interests Man Utd - Sunday's gossip.**
AC Milan are ready to let Rafael Leao leave for a cut-price fee with Manchester United interested, Jarrod Bowen could also be heading to Old Trafford, plus more.
SPORT · UK
- 3 How well do you remember this season's Premier League?.**
Test your knowledge of the 2025-26 Premier League season before the final round of fixtures.
SPORT · UK
- 4 England take three wickets in four balls as NZ's top order crumbles.**
Lauren Bell and Linsey Smith rip through the New Zealand's top order as England reduce them to 5-3 in the second T20 international at Canterbury.
SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 The 'silver gamer' is the fastest-growing demographic in UK gaming — over-65s spent £180 million on games last year.**
Cosy life-sim titles like Stardew Valley and Animal Crossing dominate. Console makers are reportedly designing larger UI for the market.
- 2 More than half of UK workers would take a 10% pay cut to never go into the office again — but only 17% of bosses say they'd offer one.**
The gap is growing again after forced return-to-office rules. HR experts say the tension shows up in resignation rates, particularly for under-35s.
- 3 Roses are out, peonies are in — UK florists report a 200% rise in peony orders for weddings this summer.**
Brides cite 'softer, less staged' aesthetics. Wholesale peony prices have crept up accordingly.
- 4 Britain's most-stolen supermarket item in 2026 isn't meat or cheese — it's olive oil, with theft up 220% year on year.**
Prices have nearly doubled in two years. Some shops have fitted security tags to single bottles, others have moved premium brands behind the counter — like cigarettes.
- 5 Loneliness is now considered a bigger health risk than smoking 15 cigarettes a day, according to NHS England.**
Social prescribing — GPs referring patients to community activities — is rolling out nationwide. Walking groups, book clubs and choirs are reportedly oversubscribed.
- 6 The average Brit checks their phone 159 times a day — but says it 'doesn't feel like that much'.**
Researchers using passive monitoring apps say we badly underestimate our own usage. Most people guess between 30 and 70 times.
- 7 Almost two thirds of us say we've cried at a podcast in the last year — grief, parenting and identity top the list of triggers.**
Researchers reckon it's the intimacy of audio that does it. The figure is even higher for under-30s, 71% of whom admit a recent podcast-induced tear.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 48% of us do **THIS** every single day. What is it?
ANSWER: STEP ON THE BATHROOM SCALES.

Q 63% of us have done **THIS** in a meeting we're meant to be paying attention to. What?
ANSWER: ONLINE SHOPPING.

TALK TOPIC

- **Researchers say the most stressful day to drive in the UK isn't Monday — it's **THIS** day.**
(Spoiler: it's Thursday.) Talk-back: what day of the week feels longest to you, and why?
- **The 'big shop' is dying — younger Brits are doing 4–6 small shops a week instead.**
Talk-back: are you a one-big-shop person or a daily-corner-shop person? And which one is your partner?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Food.** The UK's bestselling biscuit in 2025 wasn't the Custard Cream or the Hobnob — it was the humble digestive, selling over 70 million packs.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A Bristol bakery has started selling 'controversial' jam doughnuts injected with mustard instead of jam, claiming a 'small but loyal' customer base.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The colour orange is named after the fruit, not the other way around.
- More people speak English in China than in the United States.
- Cleopatra lived closer in time to the moon landing than to the building of the Great Pyramid.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time — 1/100th of a second.
- Goats have rectangular pupils, which gives them nearly 360-degree vision.
- Lightning strikes Earth about 100 times every second.
- Bees have to visit roughly 2 million flowers to make one pound of honey.
- Mosquitoes are attracted to people who've just eaten bananas.

On this day

Day 145 of the year, 220 days left in 2026. Today Africa Day (African Union); African Liberation Day (African Union, Rastafari); Christian feast day: Aldhelm; Christian feast day: Bede. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Emerald.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1976 — Cillian Murphy, Irish actor
- 1970 — Robert Croft, Welsh-English cricketer and sportscaster
- 2001 — Chloé Lukasiak, American actress and dancer
- 1944 — Charlie Harper, English singer-songwriter and producer
- 1954 — John Beck, English footballer and manager
- 1970 — Octavia Spencer, American actress and author[a]
- 1963 — Mike Myers, Canadian-American actor, singer, producer, and screenwriter
- 1959 — Julian Clary, English comedian, actor, and author

THE DAY TODAY

- 2011 — Oprah Winfrey airs her last show, ending her 25-year run of The Oprah Winfrey Show.
- 1973 — In protest against the dictatorship in Greece, the captain and crew on Greek naval destroyer Velos mutiny and refuse to return to Greece, instead anchoring at Fiumicino, Italy.
- 2000 — Liberation Day of Lebanon: Israel withdraws its army from Lebanese territory (with the exception of the disputed Shebaa farms zone) 18 years after the invasion of 1982.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1895 — The Republic of Formosa is formed, with Tang Jingsong as its president.
- 1955 — First ascent of Mount Kangchenjunga: On the British Kangchenjunga expedition led by Charles Evans, Joe Brown and George Band reach the summit of the third-highest mountain in the world (8,586 meters); Norman Hardie and Tony Streatheer join them the following day.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1966 — Explorer program: Explorer 32 launches.
- 2000 — Liberation Day of Lebanon: Israel withdraws its army from Lebanese territory (with the exception of the disputed Shebaa farms zone) 18 years after the invasion of 1982.

- 2009 — North Korea allegedly tests its second nuclear device, after which Pyongyang also conducts several missile tests, building tensions in the international community.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 146 of the year, 219 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Andrew Kaggwa; Christian feast day: Augustine of Canterbury (Anglican Communion and Eastern Orthodox); Christian feast day: Lambert of Vence; Christian feast day: Mariana de Jesús de Paredes. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Emerald.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1962 — Black, English singer-songwriter (died 2016)
- 1940 — Levon Helm, American singer-songwriter, drummer, producer, and actor (died 2012)
- 1926 — Miles Davis, American trumpet player, composer, and bandleader (died 1991)
- 1954 — Alan Hollinghurst, English novelist, poet, short story writer, and translator
- 1949 — Philip Michael Thomas, American actor
- 1981 — Jason Manford, English actor, screenwriter, and television host
- 1975 — Lauryn Hill, American singer-songwriter, producer, and actress
- 1966 — Helena Bonham Carter, English actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1948 — The U.S. Congress passes Public Law 80-557, which permanently establishes the Civil Air Patrol as an auxiliary of the United States Air Force.
- 1981 — An EA-6B Prowler crashes on the flight deck of the aircraft carrier USS Nimitz, killing 14 crewmen and injuring 45 others.
- 1972 — Cold War: The United States and the Soviet Union sign the Anti-Ballistic Missile Treaty.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1967 — The Beatles' album Sgt. Pepper's Lonely Hearts Club Band is released.
- 1991 — Lauda Air Flight 004 breaks apart in mid-air and crashes in the Phu Toei National Park in the Suphan Buri province of Thailand, killing all 223 people on board.

Coming to cinemas

MAY 2026	
FRI 15	Mortal Kombat II (+ IMAX); Is God Is; Poetic License
FRI 22	The Mandalorian and Grogu (+ IMAX)
JUNE 2026	
FRI 5	Masters of the Universe; Power Ballad
FRI 12	Scary Movie 6; new Spielberg film (+ IMAX)
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life
JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

MAY 2026		JULY 2026	
THU 14	PGA Championship begins (Golf)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
WED 20	UEFA Europa League Final	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
SAT 23	EFL Championship Play-off Final, Wembley	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
SUN 24	Premier League final day (all 10 games, 3pm BST)	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
24 MAY – 7 JUN	French Open (Tennis)	23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
THU 28	Premier League Darts Finals Night	AUGUST 2026	
SAT 30	UEFA Champions League Final	W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
JUNE 2026		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
THU 4	NBA Finals begin	22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)		
11–14 JUN	World Cup of Darts		
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)		
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)		
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon		